

Chapter 82-2

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Liang Xinhe vividly described last night's "bloodbath" at the Liang family.

Liang Shi listened as if she were hearing a story, and could even feel the intensity of last night through his words.

It really was quite a spectacular drama.

After Liang Xinhe finished speaking, he nestled into his chair and rubbed his face, sighing: "Do you think our family didn't pray to the gods this year? Why is our fate so troubled?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She answered righteously: "Feudal superstition is inadvisable."

Liang Xinhe: "?"

Liang Xinhe said helplessly: "You're the only one who can contact big brother. Send him a message and ask if he can come to work? The documents are piling up like a mountain. He has three meetings today, and I really can't handle it. My brain is about to rust. There's also a pile of crap going on at home, and I can't even focus during meetings."

Liang Shi obediently sent a message to Liang Xinzhou, asking if he was coming to work or not.

Liang Xinzhou replied concisely: [Not coming.]

Liang Shi showed the text to Liang Xinhe, indicating that she was innocent.

But while Liang Xinhe was looking, Liang Xinzhou sent another message: [No need to talk to your second brother. Just don't get involved in these matters.]

Liang Xinhe: "?"

He asked Liang Shi with a dejected expression: "Did I do something wrong? Is big brother targeting me?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "I don't know."

After a moment, looking at Liang Xinhe's expression as if he had lost his parents¹, she couldn't help but remind him: "Big brother just doesn't like you being a fence-sitter²."

"Me?" Liang Xinhe pointed at his own nose, looking incredulous. "I'm being a fence-sitter? Then what else should I do? Should I argue with Mom like he did, then also move out and just abandon the company? What would the Liang family become? Losing our managers in a single day—if word got out, wouldn't people laugh themselves to death?"

"So you think you're better than big brother at playing business mind games?" Liang Shi retorted.

Liang Xinhe was stunned, then shook his head: "That's impossible. I could never outplay big brother in my entire life."

Liang Xinhe was very self-aware.

If you ranked people's talent in business on a scale of 1-10, if Liang Xinzhou was at 7, Liang Xinhe could only be at 3.

Dongheng Group was also steadily rising under Liang Xinzhou's management. In an environment where the market was constantly being squeezed, Liang Xinzhou was doing better than Father Liang had.

So Liang Xinhe greatly admired his big brother.

But this time, Liang Xinhe felt that his big brother was going against everyone at home because he was biased.

After Liang Xinhe finished speaking, Liang Shi stared straight at him.

"You're still my little sister." Liang Xinhe immediately tried to remedy the situation. "I just think everyone's an adult now. Her coming back is just about dividing some family property. At most, everyone takes a little less and gives her a share. We don't usually keep in touch much anyway—just having a meal together during New Year and holidays would be fine. There's no need to make things so awkward. After all, we're all family."

"Look at you—didn't you used to run around everywhere too, almost never home? Now isn't that different from before." Liang Xinhe sighed. "I don't know why big brother is being so stubborn about this."

Liang Shi stared at him, still not speaking.

Liang Xinhe curled his fingers and knocked on the table. "If you have something to say, just say it. Don't play that game big brother plays with me. Also, I'm telling you all this because I consider you my real little sister—real! I don't think that person coming back can compare to you. It's mainly to make Mom and Dad happy. They're getting old, and having the family argue all day—what kind of image is that?"

"I know." Liang Shi said. "I wasn't thinking anything else either."

"Then why do you keep looking at me like that? What do you mean?" Liang Xinhe asked.

Liang Shi thought for a moment, then said in a low voice: "Do you think big brother would possibly bring shame to the Liang family?"

Liang Xinhe immediately denied it: "Impossible."

"So why don't you trust big brother?" Liang Shi said. "Big brother does everything flawlessly. So why would he suddenly act abnormally in this matter? You should think about it too."

Liang Xinhe: "....."

Inexplicably, he felt like he was being lectured.

"Big brother thinks that once that person comes back, there won't be a place for you in the family." Liang Xinhe said. "But you're still our little sister. That hasn't changed."

"That's not important." Liang Shi said. "How I am, what my position in the Liang family is—none of that is important."

"How is it not important?" Liang Xinhe's eyes widened immediately. "You are the Third Miss of the Liang family, without a doubt."

"It's not important." Liang Shi still said. "What's important now is how you all conduct yourselves at home. Why do you think last night was big brother's fault? Big brother was already being very respectful—he held a welcome banquet, the whole family eating together."

Liang Shi stood from a very objective angle to evaluate last night's farce, trying to analyze it for Liang Xinhe.

"Dad doesn't really manage the company now, right? Big brother handles everything, big and small. Granted, you can help quite a bit, but for big brother, it's still just a drop in the bucket. You experienced big brother's workload today—how was it?" Liang Shi asked him.

Liang Xinhe: ".....Very tiring."

"Big brother is already this tired, and has anyone in the family ever been considerate of him?" Liang Shi asked. "Besides, hasn't he always had this personality since he was little? You all say he treats me especially well, but have you ever seen him smile at me?"

Liang Xinhe: ".....No."

"Well, there you go. He treats everyone the same." Liang Shi said coldly. "Aside from occasionally being able to smile at clients, he's never made exceptions for anyone. So why should she expect big brother to put on a smiling face for her the moment she comes back?"

As Liang Shi spoke, she started projecting her own feelings into it, and suddenly got a bit angry.

She even felt a bit angry looking at Liang Xinhe, who had been playing fence-sitter all along.

"Just talking about how the two of them went out of town for three days—wasn't big brother busy handling everything inside and out because of that?" Liang Shi's words carried a hint of interrogation and displeasure. "Never mind that no one is grateful for his hard work, but they still want him to put on a smile? Do they deserve it? Do they?"

Liang Shi asked twice in succession, making Liang Xinhe feel guilty.

It was only after a while that Liang Xinhe realized that this "do they deserve it" also included criticism of him.

Did he deserve it?

He didn't.

Footnotes:

¹ **"As if he had lost his parents" (如喪考妣):** A Chinese idiom describing someone who looks extremely grief-stricken or dejected, as if they had just lost their parents. It's often used sarcastically to describe someone overreacting to a situation.

² **"Fence-sitter" / "Playing with mud" (和稀泥):** A Chinese expression meaning to try to smooth things over without taking a clear stance, to be wishy-washy, or to try to please both sides in a conflict without addressing the actual issues. Literally translates to "mixing thin mud."